Design Brief — Leish! Aesthetic Marketplace

Document	04 — Design Brief
Version	1.0
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Companion	05-background-scheme.md (background/gradient system)

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1. Brand Positioning

> **Leish! — where artistry is booked, not begged for.**

A curated, haute-couture marketplace for makeup artistry in the Klang Valley. It must feel closer to a **fashion house lookbook** than to a directory: dark, warm, editorial, confident. The product sells *craft* — so the interface should recede and let photography, palette and typography carry the luxury signal.

Personality (four words): *Editorial · Warm · Precise · Assured.*

Is	Is not
Champagne-on-espresso, gallery-dark	Cold blue SaaS dark mode
Serif display + mono micro-labels	Generic system sans everywhere
Restrained gold accents on CTAs	Gold-plated everything / bling
Confident, short copy	Hype, exclamation marks, emoji spam
Photography-forward	Illustration- or icon-forward

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2. Audience & Design Implications

Persona	What the design must do for them
Client (visual, comparison shopper)	Big imagery, glanceable price/rating, obvious primary CTA,
Freelance MUA (mobile-first, Instagram-native)	Fast scanning, thumb-reachable controls, status clarity
Studio Director (operational)	Dense tables that stay legible, clear status chips, deliberate
Workspace power user	Task-oriented layout, fewer flourishes, obvious system feed

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3. Design Principles

1. **Dark canvas, light content.** The espresso canvas is a constant; cards, photos and type are the light sources. Never invert to a light panel mid-flow.
2. **One gold moment per view.** Gold (`#574D3C → #A88F5A`) marks the single most important action or active state on screen. If everything is gold, nothing is.
3. **Serif for voice, mono for data.** Headlines and look names are serif; labels, prices, timestamps and badges are uppercase mono with tracking.
4. **Warmth over contrast gimmicks.** Elevation is expressed with *warm surface steps and hairline borders*, not drop shadows.
5. **Motion is punctuation.** Framer Motion entrance fades/slide-ups and one animated nav pill — no perpetual animation, no parallax theater.
6. **Honest states.** Loading, empty, error, and AI-fallback states are designed, not afterthoughts.

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4. Typography

Role	Family (token)	Usage
Display / headline	`--font-serif` → **Lora / Playfair Display**	Hero H1, section titles,
Body	`--font-sans` → **Raleway / Inter**	Paragraphs, forms, des
Micro-label	`--font-mono` → **JetBrains Mono**, uppercase, `tracking-wider`, ~11–12px	Eyebrows, badges, pric
Display alt	`--font-display` → **Space Grotesk**	Reserved; currently un

Scale (recommended): 12 (mono label) / 14 (meta) / 16 (body) / 18–20 (lead) / 24–28 (h3) / 32–40 (h2) / 56–72 (hero, serif, tight leading ~1.05).

⚠ **Known issue:** `index.html` loads Playfair Display, Plus Jakarta Sans, Space Grotesk and JetBrains Mono while `@theme` requests Raleway/Lora/Inter → those fall back to system fonts. *Reconcile the two lists (load what the theme declares, or re-point the tokens).*

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5. Color Roles

Full background system → 05-background-scheme.md.

Token	Value	Role
`--color-canvas`	`#0F0D0A`	Page background, scrims target
`--color-surface`	`#221E16`	Cards, panels
`--color-elevated`	`#14110C`	Modals, drawers, sticky bars
`--color-chip`	`#2B251B`	Chips, input fills, filter pills
`--color-line`	`#3E3628`	Hairline borders (1–2px)
`--color-accent`	`#574D3C`	Primary button fill, glow orbs (fills only)
`--color-accent-soft`	`#746853`	Control borders, focus (3.6:1 ≥ 3:1)
`--color-accent-text`	`#8F7749`	Accent-colored text (4.5:1)
`--color-accent-strong`	`#A88F5A`	Hover/active accent, headings-on-gold
`--color-fg` / `-muted` / `-dim`	`#E6E5E4` / `#ADA69A` / `#968B78`	Body / secondary / tertiary text
Deep crimson	`#751313` → `#B12220`	Secondary CTA gradient (Lookbook ”Book This Look”)
Emerald	`#10B981`	Success / confirmed status only
Amber	star ratings	Ratings only

Documented contrast (vs canvas): fg 15.4:1 · muted 8.0:1 · dim 5.8:1 · accent-text 4.5:1 · accent-strong 6.2:1 · accent-soft 3.6:1 (control borders, WCAG 1.4.11 ≥ 3:1).

Rule: never place `--color-fg-dim`/`fg-subtle` body copy on `--color-surface`; re-check contrast when layering on photography (use scrims, see background scheme).

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6. Layout & Grid

- **Max width:** ~1280–1440px content column, generous side gutters; hero and map go full-bleed.
- **Spacing scale:** 4px base (`0.25rem` → `6rem` token scale). Section rhythm: 64–96px vertical; card padding 16–24px; grid gaps 16–24px.
- **Radii:** cards `rounded-2xl/3xl` (16–24px), buttons `rounded-xl`, chips/badges `rounded-full`, inputs `rounded-xl`.
- **Grids:** MUA and studio listings in responsive card grids (1 / 2 / 3–4 columns); detail pages use a 2-column split (media left, actions right) collapsing to one column on mobile.
- **Density:** client surfaces breathe; provider dashboard tables are denser (12–14px mono cells) but retain hairline separation.

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7. Components

Component	Spec
Primary button	`bg-accent` → hover `accent-strong`, `rounded-xl`, 14–15px medium, min-h 44px (touch target), focu

Component	Spec
Secondary button	Transparent, 1px `line` border, `fg` text, hover fills `chip`
CTA gradient	`from-[#574D3C] to-[#463D2E]`; Lookbook variant `to-[#751313]` with hover `#B12220`
Card	`surface` fill, 1px `line` border, `rounded-2xl`, hover: border → `accent-soft` + `translate-y-[-2px]`, 150–2
Listing card	4:3 media with bottom fade scrim, serif name, mono price/rating row, badge chips (Verif
Chip / filter pill	`chip` fill, `rounded-full`, mono uppercase; active = `accent` fill, `fg`-on-gold text
Input	`chip` fill, 1px `line`, `rounded-xl`, placeholder `fg-subtle`, focus border `accent-soft`, label above in m
Modal	`elevated` fill, `rounded-3xl`, backdrop `backdrop-blur-sm` over canvas at 60–70% opacity, trapped fo
Status badge	mono uppercase, dot + label: pending `fg-dim`, confirmed `accent-text`, completed `emerald`, car
Rating	amber stars + `fg-muted` count in mono
Nav	sticky, scroll-condense h-20→h-16, `layoutId` active pill, blur + hairline bottom border when

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8. Motion

Interaction	Behavior	Timing
View transition	`AnimatePresence` fade + 8–12px rise	250–350ms ease-out
Nav active pill	`layoutId` spring	stiffness ~400, damping
Card hover	border + 2px lift	150–200ms
Modal	scale 0.97→1 + fade; backdrop fade	200ms
AI generation	indeterminate shimmer + rotating captions (”sampling trends…”)	loop, no bounce
Filter/search	debounced list re-flow, `AnimatePresence` on items	200ms
Reduced motion	honor `prefers-reduced-motion`: disable transforms, keep opacity	—

No autoplay video, no infinite marquee, no cursor-follow effects.

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9. Imagery

- **Direction:** editorial beauty photography — warm skin tones, directional light, deep shadows that merge into the espresso canvas.
- **Treatment:** hero images at `brightness-[0.38]` under dual scrims; gallery/detail images bottom-faded `from-[#0F0D0A]/85`.
- **Consistency:** fixed aspect boxes (4:3 cards, 16:9 galleries, 9:16 reels) to prevent layout shift; `loading="lazy"` below the fold.
- **AI-generated assets** (Image Studio) must be prompt-locked to the same look: *”haute couture editorial, warm chiaroscuro, espresso-and-gold grade”* so they sit beside stock photos invisibly.
- **Avoid:** cool-toned stock, white-background product shots, visible watermarks, clashing color casts.

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10. Voice & Copy

- **Register:** confident, warm, expert — a studio director, not a marketer.
- **Headlines:** short, serif, sentence case (”Find the artist for your moment.”).
- **Micro-labels:** mono, uppercase, tracked (”FEATURED ATELIERS”, ”FROM RM 380”).
- **Money:** always `RM` with no decimals for whole amounts; distances in `km`. *(Current UI mixes `$` and miles — must be normalized.)*
- **Errors:** plain and actionable — ”We couldn't save that booking. Check the date and try again.” never ”Error 400”.
- **AI output:** always labeled — a quiet ”sample result” chip when `source: 'fallback'`.
- **Never claim what isn't real:** remove decorative badges (”Firestore Live & Syncing”) or back them with live data; derive hero stats from actual records.

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11. Accessibility

- Contrast: maintain documented ratios; body ≥ 4.5:1, UI borders/focus ≥ 3:1.
- Keyboard: full nav reachability, visible focus (`accent-soft` ring), `Escape` closes overlays, focus trapped in modals.
- Semantics: `aria-expanded`/`aria-controls` on disclosures, labelled form fields, live regions for async results.
- Targets: ≥ 44×44px interactive areas; body text ≥ 16px.
- Motion: `prefers-reduced-motion` respected (§8).
- Images: meaningful `alt` on listing photos; decorative glows `alt=""`/`aria-hidden`.

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12. Responsive Strategy

Breakpoint	Behavior
< 640px	Single column, disclosure nav, stacked detail page, sticky bottom CTA in booking flow, map below
640–1024	2-column grids, condensed nav with ”More ▾”
> 1024	3–4 column grids, split detail layout, full nav row, map beside list

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13. Deliverables & Handoff

1. **Token source of truth:** `src/index.css` `@theme` (live) — promote `design-tokens.ts` to a generated mirror or delete it (currently unreferenced).
2. **Component inventory:** the §7 table as the canonical checklist; any new component must map to an existing recipe or add a token.
3. **QA gate:** contrast re-check per surface, keyboard pass, reduced-motion pass, RM/km copy pass.
4. **Out of scope for v1:** light theme, illustration system, icon redesign (lucide-react at 1.5–2px stroke, `fg-muted` default / `accent-strong` active).